

L'Dor Vador

HERITAGE TRAVEL



Curaçao Jewish Heritage Journey

March 3-8, 2027 · 6 days / 5 nights

TEMPLE BETH ELOHIM



Rabbi Joel Sisenwine
SPIRITUAL LEADER



Susan Alvares
Correa
TOUR LEADER



Hannah Berkeley
Cohen
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OVERVIEW

The Journey

Join Rabbi Joel Sisenwine and TBE congregant and Curaçao native Susan Alvares Correa as we embark on a remarkable journey to Curaçao, a Caribbean island with an extraordinary Jewish heritage, vibrant culture, and breathtaking beauty.

From the historic Mikvé Israel-Emanuel Synagogue (home to the oldest continuously active Jewish congregation in the Americas), to centuries-old Jewish cemeteries, historic family homes, and the colorful streets of Willemstad, we'll trace more than 375 years of Jewish life and reflect on a unique Jewish legacy that continues to thrive.

Together, we'll meet members of today's Jewish community, explore the people and places that shaped this enduring legacy, share Shabbat and Havdalah, and taste the flavors and traditions that have been passed down through generations. We'll also venture into Bandabou, rural Curaçao, to encounter Curaçao's Afro-Curaçaoan history, art, and music, placing the island's Jewish story within the broader cultural and historical landscape in which it developed.

HIGHLIGHTS

- Mikvé Israel-Emanuel Synagogue — The Snoa
- Beth Haim Blenheim Cemetery
- Jewish Legacies in Art, Architecture & Culture
- Kabbalat Shabbat at the Snoa
- Afro-Curaçaoan History, Identity & Art in Bandabou
- Open-air Havdalah Service with Sea View

AT A GLANCE

DATES

March 3-8, 2027

DURATION

6 days / 5 nights

START / FINISH

Willemstad → Willemstad
(individual arrivals and departures)

PACE

Guided touring most days, with a day of optional activities, some evening programming and group dinners

ACCOMMODATION

Renaissance Wind Creek
Curaçao Resort, Willemstad

ITINERARY AT A GLANCE

Day 1 — Arrival in the
Crossroads of the Caribbean

Day 2 — The Sephardic Story
of Curaçao

Day 3 — Jewish Legacies in
Art, Architecture & Culture

Day 4 — Curaçaoan Jewry in
Practice and on Paper

Day 5 — Optional
Programming: Afro-Curaçaoan
Identity, History, and Art

Day 6 — Farewell to Curaçao

DAY 1 · WEDNESDAY, MARCH 3, 2027

Arrival in the Crossroads of the Caribbean

Arrival Day | Welcome Dinner at 6:15 PM



Individual Arrivals in Curaçao

- Participants arrive individually and make their way to the Renaissance Wind Creek Curaçao Resort in Willemstad for check-in.
- Our journey officially begins at the hotel, allowing participants the flexibility to select the flights and travel arrangements that work best for them. Participants are therefore welcome to arrive in Curaçao earlier, extend their stay after the program, or continue onward to another destination.
- For those who would like assistance, Hannah Berkeley Cohen of L'Dor Vador Travel, who will also be accompanying us throughout the journey, will be available to assist participants individually with flight arrangements and airport transfers.
- After check-in, take some time to settle in, relax at the resort, and enjoy your first views of the Caribbean.

Welcome Dinner & Orientation

- This evening, we come together for the first time at Gouverneur Restaurant for our welcome dinner and orientation.
- Meet your fellow travelers and hosts as we introduce the journey ahead and set the stage for our exploration of Curaçao's remarkable Jewish, Caribbean, and multicultural heritage.

Overnight: Renaissance Wind Creek Curaçao Resort, Willemstad · (D)

DAY 2 · THURSDAY, MARCH 4, 2027

The Sephardic Story of Curaçao

Day Program: 9:00 AM-4:00 PM | Group Dinner at Caleo



Breakfast

- Enjoy the breakfast buffet at our resort.

Historic Willemstad

- We begin with a drive through Willemstad, a UNESCO World Heritage city renowned for its distinctive and colorful colonial architecture.

Mikvé Israel-Emanuel Synagogue — The Snoa

- Continue to Mikvé Israel-Emanuel Synagogue, affectionately known as the Snoa. Completed in 1732, it is the oldest continuously operating synagogue in the Americas and connects us to a Sephardic Jewish story whose Spanish and Portuguese roots can be traced to the Iberian Peninsula of the 1400s.
- Here, we meet the spiritual leader of the Snoa, Rabbi Martin Hirsch, who is originally from Chile.
- While at the Snoa, we have the opportunity to learn firsthand from one of the world's leading scholars on the history of Jews in Curaçao, Ron Gomes Casseres. Ron has written extensively on the topic, and can trace his personal family's history back to Sephardic immigrants who arrived on the island in 1690. Aside from his dozens of publications, he has been decorated by the Kingdom of the Netherlands for social and cultural contributions to the Curaçao community.

Jewish Museum Curaçao

- Explore the newly expanded and renovated Jewish Museum at your own pace with an audio tour, or choose to join a highlights tour with museum curator, Phyllis Meit. Phyllis is a wealth of knowledge, and is happy to share her family's unique history of how they arrived to the island via Romania.

Lunch at La Vie en Rose

- Delight in a high-tea-style lunch at La Vie en Rose, in the historic district of Scharloo, known for its elegant colonial mansions, many of which were once owned by prosperous Jewish merchants during the 19th century.

Curaçao's Historic Jewish Cemeteries

- On our way back to the hotel, we will pass the newer Jewish cemetery established in 1864, as well as historic Beth Haim Blenheim Cemetery.

- Established in 1659 by Curaçao's first 12 Jewish families, Beth Haim Blenheim is the oldest Jewish cemetery in the Caribbean. Its richly carved tombstones preserve the story of Curaçao's early Sephardic community and its far-reaching Atlantic connections.

Evening in Kura Hulanda

- Step into a walkable village within the city, Kura Hulanda - a beautifully restored area of the inner city that boasts dimly lit restaurants, live music, inviting public plazas, galleries, as well as our restaurant for the evening, Caleo.

Punda Vibes

- On Thursday nights, Punda's streets fill with local vendors, live music, open bars, and fireworks! Fireworks take place at 8:15pm, and are visible from many places in Punda or Otrobanda, including just outside our restaurant.

Overnight: Renaissance Wind Creek Curaçao Resort, Willemstad · (B, L, D)

DAY 3 · FRIDAY, MARCH 5, 2027

Jewish Legacies in Art, Architecture & Culture

Day Program: 9:00 AM-4:00 PM | Kabbalat Shabbat Under the Stars



Breakfast

- Enjoy the breakfast buffet at our resort.

Mongui Maduro Historic House

- Visit this meticulously preserved historic plantation house and discover the legacy of the Levy Maduro family, a prominent Sephardic Jewish lineage that significantly influenced Curaçao's economic and social landscape over four generations.
- The Levy Maduro family traces its Curaçao roots to 1672, when Mozes Levy Maduro settled on the island. Eight generations later, his descendant Mongui Maduro would become one of Curaçao's great collectors and preservationists. The family's commercial dynasty, founded by Salomon Elias Levy Maduro in 1837, would grow into one of the island's most influential business enterprises. Today, the Mongui Maduro Museum at Rooi Catootje tells this remarkable story through four generations of the family.

Landhuis Bloemhof & Cathedral of Thorns

- Continue to Landhuis Bloemhof, which today houses a cultural center dedicated to art, heritage, and nature.
- Learn about the history and ideals of the family that has continued to innovate at Bloemhof across generations.
- Visit the extraordinary Cathedral of Thorns, conceived as a space for reflection and healing and as a powerful metaphor for Curaçao's complex history, including colonialism and slavery.

Lunch at Number Ten

- Enjoy lunch together at Number Ten.

Chobolobo Distillery

- Discover the history and production of Curaçao's iconic Blue Curaçao liqueur, invented by a local Sephardic Jewish family.

Kabbalat Shabbat

- As the sun begins to set, we come together for Kabbalat Shabbat at the Snoa.

Shabbat Dinner

- Following services, return to the resort for an outdoor Shabbat dinner, celebrating the arrival of Shabbat together in Curaçao.

Overnight: Renaissance Wind Creek Curaçao Resort, Willemstad · (B, L, D)

DAY 4 · SATURDAY, MARCH 6, 2027

Curaçaoan Jewry in Practice and on Paper

Shabbat Morning Service: 9:30 AM - 12:00 PM | Havdalah & Dinner in Otrobanda



Breakfast

- Enjoy the breakfast buffet at our resort.

Shabbat Morning Services at the Snoa

- This Shabbat morning service, unique to the island, features prayers in Papiamentu, Portuguese, Dutch, Hebrew, English and Spanish. The service, mainly in English and Hebrew, takes place in the sanctuary almost three centuries old, complete with a rare sand floor, and stunning mahogany woodwork throughout.

Time for reflection and exploration

- After Shabbat morning services, the afternoon is intentionally left free of scheduled programming, allowing everyone to experience the island at their own pace.
- During this time, return to the hotel's infinity pool, or take a self-guided exploratory walk through Willemstad's historic center.
- A variety of optional excursions and activities will be offered by your hosts.

Havdalah on the Beach

- Join our group at the resort's poolside "beach" for a breezy embrace of the senses as we celebrate Havdalah, before strolling over to a local art gallery for bites, books, art, and literature.

Art, Books & Dinner in Historic Otrobanda

- Walk over with the group to Sebastopol 9, an art gallery housed in a monumental 18th-century residence that has remained in the same family for roughly three centuries. Today, Philip Chapman and his brothers have given the property a new cultural life as a gallery showcasing emerging Curaçaoan artists.
- Enjoy a private catered dinner buffet inside the gallery, surrounded by contemporary local art.
- During the evening, meet Anneroos Reich, a bookstore owner, active member of Curaçao's Jewish community, and board member of the Jewish Museum. Especially for our group, she will open her bookstore Hirsch & Reich outside of opening hours, presenting a curated selection of books relevant to our journey, including Judaica, regional history, literature, art, and culture.
- This encounter also offers an informal opportunity to speak with Anneroos about contemporary Jewish life in Curaçao and everyday island life, connecting the historical Jewish story explored throughout our journey with the community that lives it today.

After Dinner — Evening at Leisure

- Stroll back to the hotel at your own pace, or continue exploring the historic Otrobanda neighborhood by night. Your hotel is an easy 5-minute stroll away.

Overnight: Renaissance Wind Creek Curaçao Resort, Willemstad · (B, D)

DAY 5 · SUNDAY, MARCH 7, 2027

Optional Programming: Afro-Curaçaoan Identity, History, and Art

Day Program: 9:00 AM - 4:00 PM | Farewell Dinner



Breakfast

- Enjoy the breakfast buffet at our resort.

Depart for Bandabou

- Travel west into Bandabou, Curaçao's rural western region, where plantation history, Afro-Curaçaoan traditions, and the island's struggle for freedom remain deeply embedded in the landscape.

Tula Museum at Landhuis Kenepa

- Visit the Tula Museum, housed at the former Kenepa plantation, one of the principal sites associated with Curaçao's great slave revolt of 1795.
- We are personally welcomed by Jeanne Henriquez, historian, activist, and director of the museum.
- Through the story of Tula, leader of the 1795 uprising and today recognized as a national hero of Curaçao, Jeanne introduces us to the history of slavery, resistance, emancipation, and the continuing process of confronting Curaçao's colonial past.
- Our conversation moves beyond history to explore nation-building, national identity, collective memory, and the importance of national heroes.

Santa Cruz

- Continue to Santa Cruz, a secluded beach nestled within one of Bandabou's beautiful natural coves.
- We are joined by Pernell Saturnino, Grammy Award-winning percussionist and Berklee College of Music alumnus, for an encounter with Curaçao's musical heritage.
- Pernell introduces us to traditional Afro-Curaçaoan rhythms and instruments, including the chapi and tambú, and explores how rhythm, music, resistance, spirituality, and community are intertwined in Curaçaoan culture.
- Enjoy a breezy, open-air buffet-style lunch at the legendary home base of Juni "Captain Goodlife" Obersi, one of the island's colorful local personalities. Refresh with a cocktail on the shaded terrace overlooking the bay, or enjoy a leisurely stroll along the beach. This lunch interlude offers an opportunity to experience another side of life in rural Curaçao before continuing our journey.

Art & Identity: Yubi Kirindongo

- Continue to the home and atelier of internationally renowned Curaçaoan artist Yubi Kirindongo.
- Known especially for transforming discarded materials into powerful works of art, Kirindongo has developed a distinctive visual language rooted in Curaçao, the African diaspora, social consciousness, and the transformation of what society has cast aside. He personally welcomes us into his world and introduces us to his life, artistic philosophy, and work.
- Drinks/Cocktails will be provided.

Farewell Dinner

- On our final night in Curaçao, we unite for a festive open-air farewell dinner at our resort.
- Over dinner, we reflect on the people we have met, the stories we have encountered, and all that we have experienced together during our Caribbean journey.

Overnight: Renaissance Wind Creek Curaçao Resort, Willemstad · (B, L, D)

DAY 6 · MONDAY, MARCH 8, 2027

Farewell to Curaçao

Departure Day

Breakfast

- Enjoy a final breakfast at our resort.

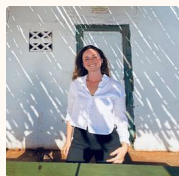
Individual Departures

- Our shared journey concludes at the Renaissance Wind Creek Curaçao Resort.
- Participants depart according to their individual travel arrangements. Those extending their stay in Curaçao or continuing onward to another destination are free to do so according to their own schedules.

End of Program · (B)



YOUR HOSTS



Hannah Berkeley Cohen **CO-FOUNDER, L'DOR** **VADOR TRAVEL**

Hannah Berkeley Cohen is a Curaçao-based journalist and

travel professional who founded L'Dor Vador Travel, a tour operator specializing in immersive Jewish heritage journeys to the island. Before moving to Curaçao, Hannah lived for many years in Havana, where she served as the principal Cuba-based stringer for The New York Times and contributed to dozens of other international media outlets. Her reporting covered defining moments in Cuba's recent history, including the reopening of the U.S. Embassy, the visits of Pope Francis and President Barack Obama, and the death of Fidel Castro.

Reporting for major media outlets gave Hannah rare access to Cuba's layered society; in 2015, she founded Cuba Rising, a bespoke travel company for Americans seeking to uncover the complex realities of a nuanced Cuba: beyond rum, cigars, and classic cars. From meetings with ambassadors to conversations with black-market money exchangers and intimate cooking lessons with grandmothers in modest home kitchens, Cuba Rising offered genuine cultural exchanges with people from all ranks of Cuban society.

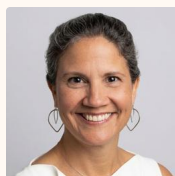
Drawing on her journalistic curiosity, regional knowledge, and talent for connecting travelers with local stories and community members, Hannah now creates meaningful journeys that explore Curaçao's fascinating history and living Jewish heritage. Representing L'Dor Vador Travel, she is partnering with Rabbi Joel Sisenwine and Susan Alvares Correa to organize the March 2027 Temple Beth Elohim journey and will serve as the group's on-island host.



Rabbi Joel Sisenwine **SPIRITUAL LEADER**

Rabbi Joel Sisenwine has served as Senior Rabbi of Temple Beth Elohim since 2000. In March 2026, Rabbi

Sisenwine led a highly successful Temple Beth Elohim journey to Curaçao, introducing participants to the island's remarkable Jewish heritage, history and culture. Inspired by that experience, he has taken the initiative to offer this meaningful journey to members of the congregation again in March 2027. Rabbi Sisenwine will lead the trip together with Susan Alvares Correa, guiding participants through a shared experience of discovery, learning and connection.



Susan Alvares Correa **TOUR LEADER**

Susan Alvares Correa is a Boston-area architect, entrepreneur and native of Curaçao. A 13th-

generation member of Curaçao's Mikvé Israel-Emanuel congregation, Susan is also a member of Temple Beth Elohim, where she serves on the Board of Directors.

She is the Founder and President of the Jewish Caribbean Culture Preservation Foundation (JCCPF), a volunteer-run U.S. nonprofit that supports preservation, digitization and cultural initiatives while reconnecting descendants and the wider Jewish community with the living heritage of historic Caribbean Jewish communities, beginning with Curaçao. Drawing on her deep personal connection to the island and its Jewish community, as well having led a successful TBE trip to Curaçao in 2026, Susan will again lead the March 2027 TBE journey alongside Rabbi Joel Sisenwine.

WHAT'S INCLUDED

- Five nights at the Renaissance Wind Creek Curaçao Resort, Willemstad
- Breakfast daily at the resort
- Meals where indicated in the itinerary
- All guided touring, entrances, private encounters and transportation as described
- Gratuities

PROGRAM NOTES

- Flights / Airport Transfers: For assistance booking flights or airport transfers, contact Hannah Berkeley Cohen at connect@ldorvadortravel.com.

- Program Flexibility: Speakers, hosts, cultural figures, and private encounters remain subject to availability. If a featured individual is unavailable, L'Dor Vador Travel will arrange an equally compelling alternative whenever possible.

NOT INCLUDED

- International airfare
- Airport transfers
- Meals not indicated in the itinerary
- Optional excursions on the free day
- Travel insurance (Recommended. Available for purchase through L'Dor Vador Travel)

- Pre- and Post-Stay Options: Extend your time in Curaçao with additional nights at the Renaissance Wind Creek Curaçao Resort. Arrive early or linger after the program to relax on the beach, dive or snorkel, and explore more of the island. Contact Hannah to make arrangements.

About L'Dor Vador Travel

L'Dor Vador Travel brings to life the compelling stories of Jewish migration across the Atlantic. Its founders combine backgrounds in journalism and bespoke travel in special-interest tourism, in destinations such as Cuba, Suriname, and Curaçao. Guided by curiosity and a commitment to historical depth, LDVD looks beyond the familiar to create meaningful connections between travelers and the people, places, and stories that shape a destination. A hands-on, service-minded approach ensures a seamless journey, allowing travelers to engage fully with one of Jewish history's most remarkable, seldom-told chapters: how Jewish life crossed the Atlantic, found hope, took root, and flourished in Curaçao.

QUESTIONS OR TO REGISTER YOUR INTEREST

Pricing and booking details will be shared with you by email. Registering your interest is non-binding, and does not constitute a booking.

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Online · <https://www.ldorvadortravel.com/groups/temple-beth-elohim/>

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